

GA.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document a Georgia owner-builder meets — what each one is, when it is needed, and which office it comes from.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. In Georgia the state minimum codes bind statewide, but permits and inspections are a local option — each county or city decides its own forms, fees, and enforcement, and some enforce nothing at all. Confirm every item with the office that will issue your permit before you rely on it. Georgia keeps almost no statewide forms — the obligations are state law, the paper is county paper.

Documents a Georgia owner-builder will encounter

Document	What it is and when you need it	Where it comes from
Building permit application	The main application, where your jurisdiction issues permits at all. Local form, local fee schedule; most metro counties file through an online portal. When: after septic, zoning, and erosion control are lined up (GA.2). Verified example of the species: Fulton County's "Building Permit Application and Site Plan Checklist."	City or county permitting department (see GA.4)
Owner-builder affidavit	No state form exists — § 43-41-17(h) requires none. Many counties require their own notarized owner-builder affidavit as local practice, and its wording is theirs, not the State's. When: at application, if required. Record your county's answer below.	County form, where required; notary usually needed
Homeowner trade permit / disclaimer	Where the county permits electrical, plumbing, and HVAC separately, you apply for the trade permits yourself under the § 43-14-13(d) self-perform carve-out; some jurisdictions add a homeowner disclaimer form acknowledging you are doing licensed-trade work with your own hands. When: with or after the building permit, per local practice.	County permitting department — county-specific
Septic construction permit application	No statewide form number: " <i>Application for such a construction permit shall be made in writing on forms provided by the County Board of Health.</i> " Decision due within 20 days of a completed application; the permit is valid 12 months and gates all physical development of the lot. When: first — before any site work, ideally before buying the land. Verified example: Hall County's "Septic Tank Permit Application."	County health department (environmental health), under DPH Rule 511-3-1

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Septic final written approval	Issued after the county's final inspection; the system may not be backfilled or used before it. Later site changes that adversely affect the system void the approval — keep it with the as-built drainfield location. When: at system completion, before building final.	County health department, under Rule 511-3-1-.03(4)
Private well — county approval, if any	You may drill on your own property if it is your primary residence (§ 12-5-131.1(a)); developing for resale requires a licensed water well contractor. The kit found no statewide domestic-well permit — some county health departments approve individual wells, and septic setbacks constrain siting. When: ask environmental health before drilling.	County health department — requirements vary
Land disturbance permit application	Required for land-disturbing activity outside the under-one-acre single-family exemption. Form names are local. When: before any disturbance begins.	Certified Local Issuing Authority (county/city); EPD district office where none exists
NPDES Notice of Intent (GAR100001)	For construction disturbing one acre or more — coverage under the stand-alone construction general permit (GAR100002/100003 for infrastructure and common developments). When: filed with EPD before discharge; confirm the current waiting period against the permit text.	EPD Watershed Protection Branch storm-water forms page, epd.georgia.gov
GDOT residential driveway application	For a driveway connecting to a state route. The regulations are strict about the paper itself: <i>"Only original forms may be used. Residential driveway applications can be obtained from the appropriate Area Office"</i> — with the Permit Application Information Sheet (Appendix B of the driveway regulations). When: permit in hand before any work in the right of way.	GDOT District Area Office for your county, via dot.ga.gov
Notice of Commencement	No state form. Draft to the § 44-14-361.5(b) contents list: contractor name/address/phone; project name, location, and legal description; owner name and address; the person at whose instance improvements are made, if not the owner; surety if bonded; construction lender if any. When: filed within 15 days of physically commencing work, and posted on site — not filing forfeits the lien screen. Some clerks publish fill-in templates; the contents list governs either way.	You draft it; filed with the clerk of superior court in the project county

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DET testing reports — blower door and duct	The two mandatory energy tests, each signed by the certified DET verifier and "provided to the code official": blower door under 5 ACH50 at completion, duct leakage at or under 6 cfm25/100 sq ft at rough-in or post-construction (excepted when ducts and air handlers sit entirely inside the envelope). When: duct test once ducts are sealed; blower door before final. Keep both forever.	Your DET verifier produces them; copies to the code official and this binder
Subcontractor certificates of insurance	Not a statutory filing — the cheap protection this kit tells you to collect anyway. Workers' comp does not reach employers with fewer than three regular employees (§ 34-9-2(a)(2)), but principal-contractor exposure for uninsured subs' workers (§ 34-9-8) is unsettled for owner-builders. When: before each sub starts.	Each subcontractor's insurer, at your request
Certificate of occupancy	Issued under your county's own administrative procedures — Georgia deletes the IRC's administration chapter, so timing and process are local. Keep it permanently: under § 43-41-17(h) the CO date starts the 24-month clock that decides whether a future sale poisons your next owner-built project.	Permitting department, at the end

Your county's answers — the two forms Georgia leaves entirely to local practice:

County owner-builder affidavit required? Y / N — form name: _____

Homeowner trade disclaimer required? Y / N — form name: _____

Sources (verified August 2026): no state owner-builder affidavit — O.C.G.A. § 43-41-17(h), read in full; homeowner trade work — § 43-14-13(d). Septic application on county forms, the 20-day decision, 12-month validity, and the final-approval rule — DPH Rule 511-3-1-.03(2)(a), (3)(a), (4), official DPH PDF. Wells — § 12-5-131.1(a). Land disturbance permit structure — § 12-7-7(a). NPDES NOI and the GAR100001 family — EPD storm-water forms page. GDOT original-forms rule and the Area Office route — GDOT Regulations for Driveway and Encroachment Control, read directly. Notice of Commencement contents, filing, posting, and forfeiture — § 44-14-361.5(b), (d). DET reports — GA IECC § R402.4.1.2, §§ R403.3.3–.3.4. Workers' comp threshold and the unsettled principal-contractor question — § 34-9-2(a)(2); § 34-9-8. County examples (Fulton, Hall) verified as examples only — your county's form names will differ.